# Research & Notable Works on Ending Homelessness

Independent reference guide | Housing affordability, effective investment, low-barrier access, and humane alternatives to punitive enforcement | October 2026

## Housing affordability and prevention

### Out of Reach 2026: The High Cost of Housing

*National Low Income Housing Coalition | 2026*

Documents the gap between wages and rental costs, highlighting the shortage of affordable housing for the lowest-income renters.

https://nlihc.org/oor/about

### Family Options Study: Long-Term Tracking Project

*U.S. Department of Housing and Urban Development | 2020*

Long-term experimental follow-up showing that housing subsidies substantially improved housing stability for families experiencing homelessness.

https://www.huduser.gov/portal/publications/family-options-study-longterm.html

### What Interventions Work Best for Families Who Experience Homelessness?

*Gubits and colleagues | 2018 | Peer-reviewed research*

Randomized evaluation found that access to long-term housing subsidies reduced homelessness and food insecurity among families.

https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC6168747/

## Housing-focused solutions and strategic investment

### Opening Doors: Federal Strategic Plan to Prevent and End Homelessness

*U.S. Interagency Council on Homelessness | 2010 | Developed under Executive Director Barbara Poppe*

Landmark federal plan developed with 19 agencies. Establishes measurable objectives and a national framework for housing, prevention, economic security and cross-sector coordination.

https://www.usich.gov/sites/default/files/document/Opening_Doors_2010_FINAL_FSP_Prevent_End_Homeless.pdf

### Homeless Investment Policy: The Path Forward for the City of Seattle

*Barbara Poppe and Associates | August 2016*

Municipal policy analysis offering a framework for more effective homelessness investments, coordinated action, and accountability for results.

https://www.seattle.gov/documents/departments/pathwayshome/bpa.pdf

### Permanent Supportive Housing: Evaluating the Evidence

*National Academies of Sciences, Engineering, and Medicine | 2018*

Independent review of permanent supportive housing, including evidence on housing stability, health outcomes and cost impacts.

https://doi.org/10.17226/25133

### Scale Housing and Supports That Meet Demand

*U.S. Interagency Council on Homelessness | Federal strategic-plan guidance*

Highlights the importance of scaling affordable housing, assistance and voluntary services to meet actual need.

https://www.usich.gov/federal-strategic-plan/scale-housing-and-supports-meet-demand

### Prevent Homelessness

*U.S. Interagency Council on Homelessness | Federal strategic-plan guidance*

Focuses on preventing new episodes of homelessness while expanding exits to stable housing.

https://www.usich.gov/federal-strategic-plan/prevent-homelessness

## Humane responses and alternatives to criminalization

### 19 Strategies for Communities to Address Encampments Humanely and Effectively

*U.S. Interagency Council on Homelessness | 2024*

Practical guidance on coordinated and housing-focused approaches to encampments, centered on dignity and stable housing opportunities.

https://www.usich.gov/guidance-reports-data/federal-guidance-resources/19-strategies-communities-address-encampments

### Improve Effectiveness of Homelessness Response Systems

*U.S. Interagency Council on Homelessness | Federal strategic-plan guidance*

Advocates accessible low-barrier shelter, housing-focused outreach, and alternatives to criminalization in response systems.

https://www.usich.gov/federal-strategic-plan/improve-effectiveness-homelessness-response-systems

**Scope:** These publications offer evidence, guidance and historical policy frameworks. Not every intervention has the same level of causal evidence, and agency guidance is distinct from peer-reviewed experimental findings.